

ABV-Indian Institute of Information Technology and Management, Gwalior

(Academic Session 2025-26, Odd Semester)

Subject: Organization Behavior

Examination: End Sem

Duration: 03 Hrs

Max. Marks: 30

Instructions: Attempt all the questions. Each question carries equal marks. Critically think before answering the questions. Answers must be very precise and clear. Unnecessary writing may lead to a negative impact on marking. You can make suitable assumptions as needed in the process of answering the questions.

1. How did L.E.K. Consulting transform its HR talent landscape through the integration of CSR initiatives and smart HR technologies?
2. Differentiate the major HR challenges faced by KPMG. How has the adoption of information technology helped address these challenges and enhanced the firm's HR-related activities?
3. Write brief explanatory notes on how human-centric IT interventions have contributed to shaping organizational behaviour at Morgan Stanley.
4. With reference to the Boston Consulting Group case, explain how purposive leadership, generative leadership, and coaching-oriented transformative leadership have influenced HR practices and enhanced overall firm performance.
5. Examine the role of information technology in addressing key soft organizational challenges at Kearney, such as fostering a high-pressure culture leading to HR burnout and maintaining diversity across global operations.
6. List the key benefits of the digital HR strategy implemented at Ernst & Young (EY) in overcoming challenges related to balancing global consistency with local flexibility, sustaining organizational culture in a hybrid work environment, and mitigating information overload and employee burnout.

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Section A

1. Write Detailed Notes on *any two* of the following: **(10 Marks)**
 - a) What are the three key elements of motivation? What are some early theories of motivation? How applicable are they today?
 - b) What are the similarities and differences between self-determination theory and goal-setting theory?
 - c) Why is employee job engagement important to managers?
2. Write Detailed Notes on *any two* of the following: **(10 Marks)**
 - a) In what ways can leaders create ethical organizations?
 - b) How can leaders have a positive impact on their organizations through building trust and mentoring?
 - c) What are the challenges to our understanding of leadership?

Section B

Passage 1: In general, people worldwide are unhappy with—and demotivated by—their perception of inequity, even when their estimates of the ratios are far below the reality. Taking the German example further, the ideal ratio of CEO pay to unskilled workers, as judged by study participants, was around 7:1. To put it all together, people think the ratio should be 7:1, believe it is 18:1, and don't realize it is actually 151:1. For all the countries worldwide in the study, the estimated ratios were above the ideal ratios, meaning participants universally thought CEOs are overpaid.

How does this affect the average worker's motivation? It appears that the less a person earns, the less satisfied the person is with the pay gap. Yet, virtually everyone in the study wanted greater equality. The ideal ratio, they indicated, should be between 5:1 and 4:1, whereas they thought it was between 10:1 and 8:1. They believed skilled employees should earn more money than unskilled individuals but that the gap between them should be smaller.

No one in the United States would likely think the 354:1 ratio is going to dip to the ideal of 7:1 soon, although some changes in that direction have been suggested. Other countries have tried to be more progressive. The Social Democratic Party in Switzerland proposed a ceiling for the ratio of 12:1, but putting a cap into law was considered too extreme by voters. No countries have yet been able to impose a maximum ratio successfully.

Therefore, the job of restoring justice perceptions has fallen to CEOs themselves. Many CEOs, such as Mark Zuckerberg of Facebook and Larry Page of Google, have taken \$1 annual salaries, though they still earn substantial compensation by exercising their stock options. In one extremely recent example, Gravity CEO Dan Price cut his salary by \$1 million to \$70,000, using the money to give significant raises to the payment processing firm's employees. Price said he expects to "see more of

this.” In addition, shareholders of some companies, such as Verizon, are playing a greater role in setting CEO compensation by reducing awards when the company underperforms.

Questions on Passage 1

- i. What do you think is the ideal ratio? Why might the ideal vary from country to country?
- ii. How does the executive compensation issue relate to equity theory? How should we determine what is a “fair” level of pay for top executives?
- iii. The study found that participants thought performance should be essential or very important in deciding pay. What might be the positive motivational consequences for average employees if CEO pay is tied to performance?

(10 Marks)

Or

Passage 2: The 19th-century German philosopher Frederick Nietzsche’s maxim “That which does not kill us, makes us stronger” can be applied to leaders of organizations today. British Prime Minister Winston Churchill offered slightly different advice to the students in his commencement speech at the Harrow School on October 29, 1941, when he said, “Never give in, never, never, never, never—in nothing, great or small, large or petty—never give in except to convictions of honor and good sense. Never yield to force; never yield to the apparently overwhelming might of the enemy.”

Antonio Horta-Osorio, the Portuguese banker who became CEO of Santander UK in 2006 and assumed the helm of Lloyds Banking Group in March 2011, demonstrates the kind of attitude that Churchill’s speech describes. Horta-Osorio encountered serious personal problems that led the board to grant him a sabbatical from his leadership position at the bank. An avid tennis player, a scuba diver who routinely encountered sharks, and a 12-hour-a-day banker, Horta-Osorio had been in his position at Lloyds for just eight months when he was granted a medical leave of absence to recover from insomnia and exhaustion, which were symptoms of stress. Confidential sources speculated that he was unable to meet the demands of the position—turning around a bank in trouble—and his inexperience in leading a large complex bank brought about his medical problems. Some financial pundits believed that he would never recover sufficiently to resume his leadership at the bank. However, on January 9, 2012, some two months later, Horta-Osorio proved them wrong.

By his account, during his recovery process, he reflected on the experience and learned that all people are human with strengths and weaknesses. Furthermore, since his return to the bank, he has managed to strengthen the bank’s position in the industry, showing as a top performer among major British banks. Horta-Osorio’s persistence, in combination with other leadership traits, enabled him to succeed where non-leaders may not have. After getting a “reality check” on his personal and mental health, he persevered, developed his strategy, remained focused and spirited, and called on others for support rather than succumb to the negativism of naysayers.

Questions on Passage 2

- i. What leadership traits does Antonio Horta-Osorio demonstrate as a result of his ability to resume his role at Lloyds Bank after such a personal issue?
- ii. To what degree is it possible to develop leadership traits? Are they innate? What are some ways one can develop persistence?

(10 Marks)

*****Wish You All the Best*****

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Section B

Passage 1: In general, people worldwide are unhappy with—and demotivated by—their perception of inequity, even when their estimates of the ratios are far below the reality. Taking the German example further, the ideal ratio of CEO pay to unskilled workers, as judged by study participants, was around 7:1. To put it all together, people think the ratio should be 7:1, believe it is 18:1, and don't realize it is actually 151:1. For all the countries worldwide in the study, the estimated ratios were above the ideal ratios, meaning participants universally thought CEOs are overpaid.

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By his account, during his recovery process, he reflected on the experience and learned that all people are human with strengths and weaknesses. Furthermore, since his return to the bank, he has managed to strengthen the bank’s position in the industry, showing as a top performer among major British banks. Horta-Osorio’s persistence, in combination with other leadership traits, enabled him to succeed where non-leaders may not have. After getting a “reality check” on his personal and mental health, he persevered, developed his strategy, remained focused and spirited, and called on others for support rather than succumb to the negativism of naysayers.

Questions on Passage 2

- i. What leadership traits does Antonio Horta-Osorio demonstrate as a result of his ability to resume his role at Lloyds Bank after such a personal issue?
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↑ eff.

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